

Qinrui XIAHOU

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EDUCATION

The University of Hong Kong, HKU Business School

Hong Kong SAR

PhD in Economics

2022 – 2026

- **Focus:** Environmental Economics & Development Economics
- **Thesis Advisory Committee:** Prof. Guojun He, Prof. Jin Li, and Prof. Yanhui Wu
- **Thesis Examination Committee:** Prof. Jing Cai (UMD), Prof. Uta Schönberg, Prof. Hui Li, and Prof. Bingjing Li
- **Scholarships:** Hong Kong PhD Fellowship (HKPFS, 2022-26), HKU Presidential PhD Scholarship (HKU-PS, 2022-26), FBE PhD Research Progress Award (2024-25), FBE PhD Entrance Scholarship (2022)
- **Grants:** National Natural Science Foundation of China (NSFC) Young Student Basic Research Program for PhD Candidates (Sole PI, RMB 300,000, 2025-27), MIT J-PAL Project AI Evidence Full RCT Grant (Co-PI, USD 165,000, 2026-27), Research Postgraduate Student Innovation Award (PI, HKD 50,000, 2026), Additional Funding from RGC for Supporting Research Needs of HKPFS Awardees (PI, HKD 19,454, 2024-25)
- **Leadership:** Mentor to 2024 YDC Youth Ambassadors, Home and Youth Affairs Bureau of Hong Kong SAR

Yale University, School of the Environment

New Haven, CT

Master of Environmental Science

2019 – 2021

- **Focus:** Climate Change Economics and Policy (Academic Advisor: Professor Robert O. Mendelsohn)
- **Leadership:** Teaching Fellow at Yale Department of Economics, Student Research Fellow at Yale Hixon Center for Urban Ecology, Student Associate of the Yale Climate Change and Health Initiative

Renmin University of China, School of Environment & Natural Resources

Beijing, China

Bachelor of Economics of Resources and Environment

2015 – 2019

- **GPA:** 3.92/4.0 (Ranked 1/24)
- **Honors:** Outstanding Graduate, GCL Scholarship (one of the ten recipients in the whole university)
- **Leadership:** Chinese Youth Delegate to the 22nd UN Climate Change Conference (one of ten), Guest Speaker at the International Youth Summit on Energy and Climate (IYSECC 10.0), Head of Press Corps

WORKING PAPERS

He, G., & Xiahou, Q. (2026). *The Demand, Supply, and Market Responses of Corporate ESG Actions: Evidence from a Nationwide Experiment in China*. Available at SSRN 5291594. (Submitted to the **Review of Financial Studies**)

- **Presentations:** SFA Annual Meeting (Palm Springs, 2026, Scheduled, **Best Paper Award**), Future Scholars in Finance Forum (Tsinghua University, 2026), Asia Meeting-China of the Econometric Society (HKU, 2026), NBER Chinese Economy Working Group Meeting (CUHK, 2025), Paris December Finance Meeting (Paris, 2025), CAFM (Seoul, 2025, **Best Paper Award**), Monash Environmental Economics Workshop (Monash University, 2025), Chinese Economy Workshop (HKU, 2025), HEC-HKUST Sustainable Finance Workshop (HKUST, 2025), EEA Congress (Bordeaux School of Economics, 2025), GRASFI (Paris Dauphine University, 2025), CES China Annual Conference (Sun Yat-sen University, 2025), CFRC (Tsinghua University, 2025), Asian Economic Development Conference (PKU, 2025), CCER Summer Institute (PKU, 2025), ICCDS (SJTU, 2025), CAERE (SUFU, 2025), IFABS (Oxford, 2025), Inaugural ASU-HKU Interdisciplinary Conference (HKU, 2025)

Chen, H., He, G., & Xiahou, Q. (2026). *Delegation, Monitoring, and Engagement: A Field Experiment in Supply Chain Governance*. (Invited to Submit to the Special Issue of the **Journal of Development Economics**)

- **Presentations:** NBER Organizational Economics Working Group Meeting (Cambridge, 2026, Scheduled), Conference in memory of Professor Elisabeth “Betty” Sadoulet (UC Berkeley & JDE, 2026, Scheduled), Annual Conference on China and the Global Economy (HKU, 2026, Scheduled), IMO-ESF Workshop (IESE Business School, 2026), CCER Summer Institute (PKU, 2026), *Organization Science* Paper Development Workshop (PKU, 2025)

Kang, L., Li, S., Xiahou, Q., & Zhang, P. (2024). *Gone with the Aid: How Paired Assistance Program Affects High-Stakes College Choices*. Available at SSRN 4977681. (Revise & Resubmit at the **Journal of Urban Economics**)

- **Presentations:** Jinan-SMU Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (Jinan University, 2025), Sino-Japanese SPACE Workshop (Hitotsubashi University, 2025), Forum for Young Scholars on China’s Education Finance Research (PKU, **Best Presentation Award**, 2025), CCER Summer Institute (PKU, 2025), Summer Meeting in Urban Economics (PHBS, 2025)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Errors, Efforts, and Earnings: AI-Driven Field Experiment in Suboptimal Labor Supply Decisions (with Guojun He and Cheng Zheng)

- Climate Change, Migration and the Design of Transportation Networks (with Guojun He, Shuo Li, and Lixin Xie)
- The “Shadow Principal”: Party Organization and the Dual-Agency Problem in Chinese Corporate Governance

AD-HOC JOURNAL REVIEWER

- *The Economic Journal (EJ)*, *Management Science (MS)*, *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management (JEEM)*, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization (JEBO)*, *China Economic Review (CER)*, *Scientific Reports*

PRE-DOCTORAL PUBLICATIONS

- Fraas, A., Lutter, R., Murphy, J., **Xiahou, Q.**, Potter, J., & Gosling, S. D. (2025). What are the effects of early childhood exposure to environmental lead on personality? *Journal of Benefit-Cost Analysis*, 16: 13–27.
- Dolphin, G., & **Xiahou, Q.** (2022). World carbon pricing database: Sources and methods. *Scientific Data*, 9: 573.
- **Xiahou, Q.**, Springer, C. H., & Mendelsohn, R. (2022). The effect of foreign investment on Asian coal power plants. *Energy Economics*, 105: 105752.
- Liu, J., Yin, M., **Xia-Hou, Q.**, Wang, K., & Zou, J. (2021). Comparison of sectoral low-carbon transition pathways in China under the nationally determined contribution and 2 °C targets. *Renewable and Sustainable Energy Reviews*, 149: 111336.
- Liu, J.-L., Wang, K., **Xiahou, Q.-R.**, Liu, F.-M., Zou, J., & Kong, Y. (2019). China’s long-term low carbon transition pathway under the urbanization process. *Advances in Climate Change Research*, 10: 240–249.
- Liu, J., **Xiahou, Q.**, Wang, K., Zou, J., & Kong, Y. (2019). Medium and long-term low-carbon development pathway of China’s industrial sector. *China Soft Science*, (11): 31–41 (in Chinese).
- Wang, K., & **Xiahou, Q.** (2017). Progress and prospects of global climate negotiations after the Paris Agreement. *Journal of Environmental Economics*, 2: 141–152 (in Chinese).

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Resources for the Future

Washington, DC

Research Analyst (35 hours/week)

June 2021 – August 2022

- Conducted the empirical analysis and co-authored a paper on the long-term effect of childhood lead emissions
- Developed a comprehensive jurisdiction-sector-year level carbon pricing database using GitHub, R, and Python
- Coded a structural model and implemented simulations of the US land use conversion and its carbon implications

Yale School of the Environment

New Haven, CT

Research Assistant, Professor Kenneth Gillingham (20 hours/week)

September 2019 – May 2021

- Scraped data on rooftop solar suitability and estimated an instrumental variable model for the Solarize Campaign
- Modeled the energy-saving effects of the Clean Energy for America Act for the US Senate Committee on Finance

Yale Department of Economics

New Haven, CT

Teaching Fellow for Economics of Natural Resources (20 hours/week)

August 2020 – December 2020

- Taught 48 TA sections on microeconomic theories and environmental economics
- Led weekly discussions on environmental issues such as the global oil market and climate change modeling

Yale Emergency Support Team

New Haven, CT

Data Analyst (20 hours/week)

April 2020 – May 2020

- Designed and developed the interactive COVID-19 curve model for the City of New Haven with three teammates
- Recoded the curve model from Python to R and Excel for the New Haven Mayor’s Office

The Environmental Research Center, Duke Kunshan University

Jiangsu, China

Research Assistant (Remote), Professor Junjie Zhang (20 hours/week)

August 2017 – June 2019

- Prepared a policy memo on rationales, actions, and obstacles of the US withdrawal from the Paris Agreement
- Led the writing of the technical report that evaluated the impact of the US reversing climate change policies

Programme of Energy and Climate Economics, Renmin University of China

Beijing, China

Research Assistant, Professor Ke Wang & Ji Zou (20 hours/week)

December 2015 – June 2019

- Co-authored three papers on China’s long-term low-carbon transition based on energy modeling using LEAP
- Drafted the section Global Climate Governance Regime in the textbook *Economics of Climate Change Mitigation*

CERTIFICATES

- CFA Certificate in Sustainable Investing (Issued 2024, ID: 101743872)
- MITx MicroMasters Program in Statistics and Data Science (2021–2023)